

▼ AIRCO D.H.9A "NINAK"

Date 1918 **Origin** UK
Wingspan 14.03m (46ft)
Length 9.22m (30¼ft)
Top speed 183kph (114mph)
Engine 294.1kW (400hp)
 Packard Liberty 12

Intended as an improvement on the previous models of its series, the D.H.9 proved to be an embarrassing failure; it was not until this modified version, powered by the American Liberty engine, entered service that it redeemed itself. It carried a 300kg (660lb) bomb load.

American-made
Liberty engine

Observer had a
single .303in
Lewis gun

New semi-streamlined
fuselage design incorporated
internal bomb bay

Twin engines in the
nose geared to a single
"pusher" propeller

Single engine in the nose
with "puller" propeller

Tail fin

Under-wing racks could
carry 180kg (400lb)
of bombs

Wings made of
plywood-covered
spruce ribs and spars

▼ VICKERS VIMY

Date 1918 **Origin** UK
Wingspan 20.75m (68ft)
Length 13.28m (43½ft)
Top speed 160kph (100mph)
Engine Two 264.7kW (360hp)
 Rolls-Royce Eagle VIII in-line V-12s

The Vimy missed combat service during World War I by a matter of weeks, but it went on to be the British Royal Air Force's lead bomber until 1925. By that time it had achieved everlasting fame as the first aircraft to cross the Atlantic.

Twin Rolls-Royce engines mounted well
inboard, directly above undercarriage struts

▲ ZEPPELIN STAAKEN

Date 1917 **Origin** Germany
Wingspan 42.2m (138½ft)
Length 22.1m (72½ft)
Top speed 135kph (84mph)
Engine 4 x 161.8kW (220hp)
 Daimler-Benz Bz.IVs in wing nacelles;
 2 x 117.6kW (160hp) D.IIs in nose

The most remarkable aircraft built for the *Luftstreitkräfte* (the German Air Force), the giant R-series Zeppelins had four, five, or six engines, and could deliver a ton or more of bombs to targets (such as those in London, England), with precision.

Forward gun position had two Lewis guns on a
Scarff ring mount; co-pilot doubled as gunner

Glazed nose allowed
bomb-aimer to see target

Biplane tail with twin
fixed fins and rudders